

DMDM Hydantoin



What is it?

DMDM hydantoin is a preservative. It is in many personal care products, industrial products, and sometimes topical medications. It is also a formaldehyde releaser.

Formaldehyde releasers are chemicals that may release formaldehyde. For this reason, if you are allergic to DMDM hydantoin, you may also need to avoid formaldehyde and formaldehyde releasers.

DMDM HYDANTOIN can also be known as:

- Dimethyl dimethyl hydantoin
- Dimethyloldimethylhydantoin
- 1,3-Dimethylol-5,5-dimethylhydantoin
- 1,3-Bis(hydroxymethyl)-5,5-dimethylhydantoin
- Dantoin
- DMDMH-55
- Mackstat DM
- Nipaguard DMDMH
- 1,3-Bis(hydroxymethyl)-5,5-dimethyl-4 -imidazolidine-2,4-dione (+)

Some Possible Uses of DMDM HYDANTOIN / Where it might be found:

- Make-up, make-up remover, toner
- Cleanser, cream, lotion, after shave
- Shampoo, conditioner, hair styling products
- Soap, body wash, bubble bath
- Mouthwash, root canal disinfectant
- Antiperspirant, hygiene spray
- Sunscreen, After-sun products
- Nail polish, cuticle remover, nail hardener
- Hand soap
- Laundry detergent, fabric softener

- Facial tissue, moist wipes, baby wipes
- Pet care items
- Paper (i.e. products, pulp, glazed)
- Newsprint, cardboard, magazines
- Grocery sacks, plastic bags
- Wet strength paper towels
- Money
- Photocopy toner, Photo developer
- Casts
- Foam insulator
- Bonded leather, fire resistant items
- Fertilizer
- Mildew resistant finish, preservative
- Embalming fluid, tissue fixative
- Waterproof glue, adhesive, rubber cement
- Latex emulsion, ink, etching material
- Paint (i.e. water based, primer, stripper)
- Wax, polish, wood cleaner, finish
- Plywood, masonite, particle board, MDF
- Asphalt shingles, flooring, filling agent
- Wood, coal, kerosene, charcoal smoke
- Smoke from cigars and cigarettes
- Natural gas combustion
- Tattoo ink

Other sources of DMDM HYDANTOIN / FORMALDEHYDE RELEASER exposure:

Some topical medicated products may contain DMDM hydantoin and/or formaldehyde releasers.

Some examples include:

- Acne pads and cleansers
- Antifungals
- Anti-itch cream/gel/lotion
- Antiseptic spray
- Atopiclair
- Calcipotriene cream

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DMDM Hydantoin



- Corticosteroids (clobetasol emollient cream, fluticasone cream and lotion, halobetasol cream)
- Crotamiton cream and lotion
- Ketoconazole shampoo
- Permethrin cream

Other products that might react like DMDM HYDANTOIN / FORMALDEHYDE RELEASERS:

You may need to avoid formaldehyde and its releasers, including:

- Imidazolidinyl urea
- Diazolidinyl urea
- Dimethyl dimethyl (DMDM) hydantoin
- Quaternium-15
- Bronopol (2-bromo-2-nitropropane-1,3-diol)
- Hexahydro-1,3,5-tris(2-hydroxyethyl)-s-triazine
- Tris nitromethane (i.e. Tris Nitrol)
- Sodium hydroxymethylglycinate
- Dimethyl imidazolidinone
- Dimethylol dihydroxyethyleneurea
- Melamine, Methenamine
- 1-(cis-3-Chloroallyl)-3,5,7-triaza-1-azoniaadamantane chloride
- Dowicil 75, Dowicil 100, Dowicil 200, Germall 116, Glydant, Grotan BK, Grotan B
- Triadine 10, Onyxdine 200, Onyxdine 500, Vancide TH, Myacide BT, Myacide AS

package. Or look at the manufacturer's or store's website.

Tell your health care providers and others that take care of you about your allergy. Ask them to avoid items with formaldehyde and formaldehyde releasers. Tell your pharmacist as well.

To find a possible workplace exposure, check the ingredients list. Consult Material Safety Data Sheets (MSDS) too. Or contact the manufacturer. Use of protection (i.e. clothing) or avoidance (i.e. a change in jobs) may be necessary.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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What should I do to avoid DMDM HYDANTOIN?

Check the ingredients of all items you use. Look for the names above. Products change often, so be sure to read all labels. For products already at home, go to the store and inspect the original

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